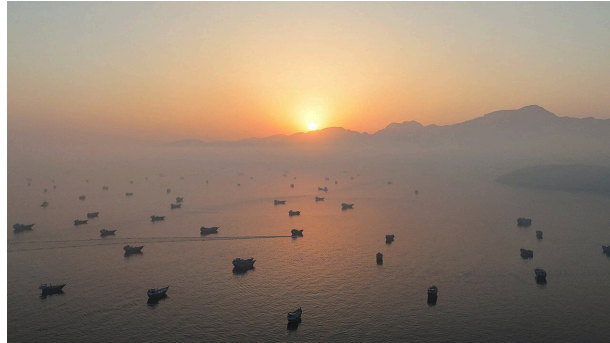


World in Brief: America lifts sanctions on Iranian oil; Vance says Iran will host nuclear inspectors



Photograph: Reuters

America lifted sanctions on **Iranian oil and petrochemical exports** for 60 days. This paves the way for America to import Iranian oil for the first time since Iran's revolution in 1979. The temporary licence does not authorise sales to Cuba, North Korea or Russian-occupied parts of Ukraine. Meanwhile the [price of Brent crude](#), the global benchmark, fell below \$76 a barrel.

Iran said it will set up a “telephone hotline” to co-ordinate the passage of ships through the Strait of Hormuz and “resolve any misunderstandings” between itself, America and other countries as the waterway reopens. Earlier J.D. Vance, America's vice-president, said [Iran had agreed](#) to admit UN nuclear-weapons inspectors. He also suggested that unfrozen Iranian assets would have to be spent on American agricultural products.

Andy Burnham was sworn in as a member of Parliament. The [former mayor of Greater Manchester](#) will almost certainly replace **Sir Keir Starmer** as leader of the Labour Party and thus as Britain's prime minister. Sir Keir said he would resign earlier on Monday, having lost the support of his party. Nominations for his

replacement will open on July 9th, but Mr Burnham has no serious rivals.

Shares in **SpaceX** fell for a third consecutive trading day, losing 16% of their value. Elon Musk's rocketry-and-AI company is now valued at around \$2trn, down from a peak of \$3trn on June 16th. Still Mr Musk need not shed a tear—SpaceX's shares are trading at nearly \$20 higher than their [debut price](#). And despite the losses, he remains a trillionaire.

Heineken, a Dutch brewer, appointed Rafael Oliveira as its boss. The former head of JDE Peet, a coffee supplier, will be the first outsider to ever take the role. He is tasked with boosting lacklustre sales and cutting 6,000 jobs. Over the past five years Heineken's share price has fallen by a third as demand for beer has flattened. Shares rose by 2% on the news.

Tata Electronics said it had been hacked. On June 12th World Leaks, a ransomware group, posted more than 200,000 files allegedly stolen from [the Indian conglomerate](#), claiming they included designs and specifications belonging to Tata clients, including Tesla and Apple. The company said the breach had “no impact on our operations across businesses”.

Lionel Messi became the **World Cup's** highest-ever goal scorer, hitting the net twice for Argentina in a match against Austria. Mr Messi, playing in his sixth consecutive [World Cup](#), now has 18 goals. Meanwhile, Kylian Mbappé—who will surely one day overhaul Mr Messi—also scored twice for France against Iraq, putting him two goals behind the Argentine.

Figure of the day: 2.6%, America's personal-saving rate in April, the lowest it has been since banks began collapsing during the financial crisis in 2008. Read about the [more benign reasons](#) why the rate has been falling.

Britain loses its head



Photograph: Getty Images

Andy Burnham, the Labour Party’s “king of the north”, is back in Parliament, having left nine years ago to become mayor of Greater Manchester. He has returned as a [prime minister-in-waiting](#); Sir Keir Starmer’s announcement of his resignation on Monday has set up a contest that looks likely to be a coronation. Mr Burnham could be in Downing Street as soon as mid-July.

He will face many of the same problems that his predecessor did. Sir Keir lost the confidence of Labour MPs, who now have a taste for rebellion. Mr Burnham will come under pressure to take the government in a more leftist direction, not least to combat the rise of the left-populist Green Party. For now his biggest attribute is that he seems like a winner. That will put him in a tricky position if his popularity declines sharply, as has happened for every recent prime minister.

The anxieties of European business



Photograph: AP

Investors in European stock markets breathed a sigh of relief when America and Iran agreed to end hostilities. Their truce [already seems shaky](#). But at least America has signalled intent to bring energy prices down. Flash figures for June released on Tuesday by S&P Global, a financial-information firm, suggest that the euro zone's economic downturn is easing. The purchasing-managers' index stood at 49.5, a whisker below the stagnation mark of 50, but up from 48.5 in May. Most of the responses had been recorded before news of the Iran peace deal.

In April industrial production had yet to take a hit, to the surprise of many. Overall, sentiment in the manufacturing sector has held up well; the latest numbers signal another month of modest growth in output. The rebound in June mostly came from the services sector, which had previously taken the largest hit from the war as inflation discouraged household spending. While still high, price pressures are slowly subsiding.

Amazon primes consumers to spend



Photograph: Getty Images

Amazon began its annual Prime Day sales on Tuesday. Over four days, the e-commerce giant will try to entice its customers, especially in America, to spend lots. Despite their [gloomy views of the economy](#), American shoppers have continued swiping their cards. Amazon's sales hit \$104bn in the first three months of 2026 in North America, a 12% rise over the previous year. But much of that growth came from discounted items, making events like Prime Day all the more important.

A successful round of sales will help Amazon swat away Walmart, a rival that has launched a late June sale to compete with Prime Day. Walmart hopes the switch will help it take back the title of America's largest firm by revenue from Amazon. The two are competing to offer steeper price cuts, speedier returns, more brands and expanding into services, including health care. With June's sales each will hope to score a knockout at the checkout.

A test for Zohran Mamdani



Photograph: Bloomberg via Getty Images

New York holds primary elections on Tuesday, and a few Democratic congressional races have attracted national attention and millions of dollars in spending by outside groups. Different AI companies have poured money into both opposing and, confusingly, supporting a candidate who advocates regulating the technology more strictly. Mike Bloomberg, the city's billionaire former mayor, spent \$10m backing another candidate, a former staffer. John F. Kennedy's grandson is in the mix. And that is just one race.

One person connecting several competitive primaries is Zohran Mamdani. The leftist new mayor has upended races in the Bronx, Brooklyn and Queens [by endorsing insurgent challengers](#), who are running as democratic socialists. For them the lesson for the Democrats of past defeats is not to moderate, but to charge the barricades. Strident opposition to Israel unites them. The results could establish Mr Mamdani as a kingmaker, or cause the Democratic Party to tear itself apart.

Can India weather its weakened monsoon?



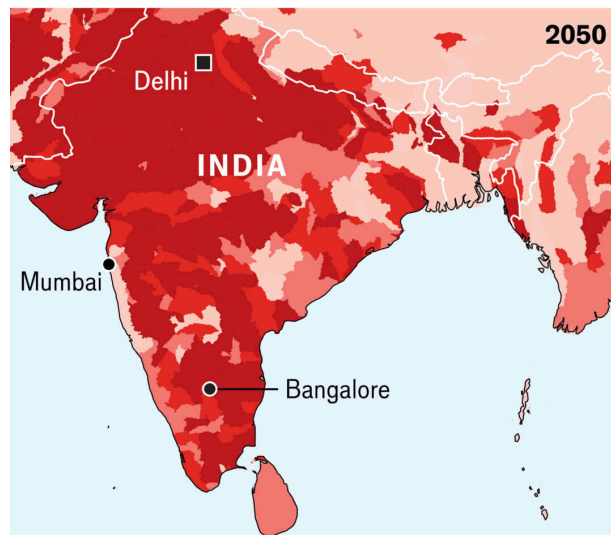
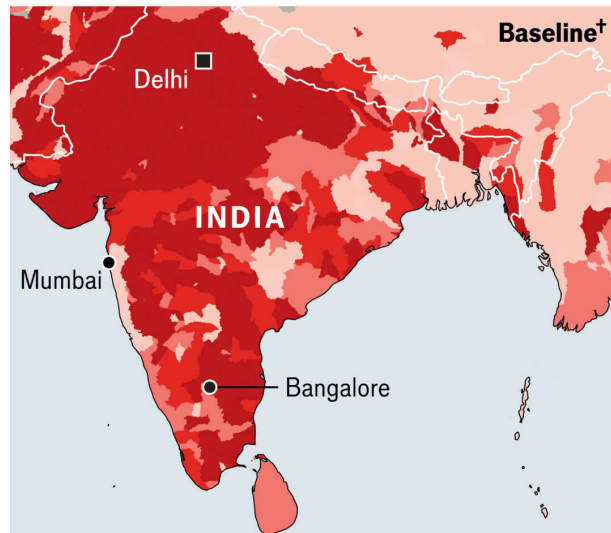
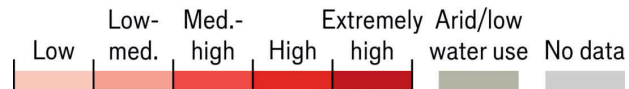
Photograph: Getty Images

Last week, officials in Mumbai restricted water access after the reservoirs around India's financial capital dwindled to just 10% of capacity. It was a great relief, then, when the first fat drops of rain fell on Sunday. The India Meteorological Department is expected to officially announce the monsoon's arrival in Mumbai by Tuesday at the latest.

It will probably be too little, too late. This summer's monsoon, which has already begun elsewhere, is unusually weak: nationwide rainfall has been almost 40% lower than the June average. That is bad news for the hundreds of millions of Indians whose livelihoods depend on farming, and for the economy, which will see food inflation spiral just after the Iran war hit energy prices. The most likely culprit is El Niño, a recurring climatic pattern that drives up temperatures and alters the distribution of rainfall. The one just begun [appears particularly strong](#): a gloomy forecast for one of the world's largest agricultural producers.

Dry and drier

Water stress*



*Ratio of water withdrawal to supply [†]1979-2019

Source: Aqueduct 4.0 World Resources Institute, 2023

Daily quiz



Illustration: Sandra Navarro

We will serve you a new question each weekday. On Friday your challenge is to give us all five answers and tell us the theme. Email your responses (and your home city and country) by 1700 BST on Friday to [\[email protected\]](#). We'll pick three winners at random and crown them on Saturday.

Tuesday: The singer Concetta Rosa Maria Franconero went under which stage name?

Monday: Those born between July 23 and August 22 are generally associated with which Zodiac sign?

*Sometimes it is the people no one
imagines anything of who do the
things that no one can imagine.*

Alan Turing